The Sādhana of the Blessed Hevajra Called The Stages of the Four Realities

Bhagavān Hevajra Tattvacaturkrama Sādhana · Toh 1248 · Derge Tengyur
བཅོམ་ལྡན་འདས་དགྱེ་པའི་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྙིང་པའི་ཐབས་དང་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ནོར་བུའི་རྣམ་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ།

The Sādhana of the Blessed Hevajra Called The Stages of the Four Realities, known in Sanskrit as the Bhagavān Hevajra Tattvacatuṣkrama Sādhana and in Tibetan as Chomden Dé Gyepé Dorjé Druppé Tap Dekho Nanyi Zhiyi Rimpa, is a ritual and meditation manual for the practice of Hevajra, the deity of the Hevajra Tantra, together with his consort Nairātmyā. It is attributed to the Indian master Kambala, and is said to have been translated into Tibetan by the paṇḍita Vairocanarakṣita and the translator Lan Darma Lodrö. The work is arranged in four stages of reality. It covers the preparations of compassion, empowerment and a secluded dwelling; the visualization of the maṇḍala and its goddesses; the recitation of their mantras; and meditation on the reality of the self, in which all appearances are seen as illusion-like and nonconceptual. It closes with torma offerings to the guardians of the directions, prayers of aspiration and dedication, and advice for carrying the practice into daily life. It is Toh 1248 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the tantra commentaries, among the sādhana texts of the Hevajra cycle.

In the language of India: bhagabān hevajra tattva caturkrama sādhanaṃ nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Sādhana of the Blessed Hevajra Called The Stages of the Four Realities.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

Having paid homage to Heruka, nondual skillful means and wisdom,
Together with the goddess Nairātmyā,
For those who have attained that reality and have faith and good fortune,
I shall write The Stages of the Four Realities.

First, look upon beings with great compassion.
Purified by the restoration ceremony, train your mind streams step by step.
Enter the maṇḍala of this tantra and receive the empowerments;
Knowing reality, and with permission granted, meditate on the four abodes.

In a charnel ground or another secluded and delightful place,
Well seated on a seat of crossed vajras,
To guard the three, oneself, the yoga and the site,

First bathe with the five nectars and the rest.
Meditate on the four immeasurables, and view the deity and oneself.
Reciting the protection mantra rakṣa, make the net and tent.
On a well-placed support set the five nectars and five lamps;
Make offerings of flowers and the rest, and cast the torma.
With a field-born consort or the like, a well-trained knowledge consort,
With good companions as support, or else alone, practice without fear.

From the black seed hūṃ in one's own heart
Five lights radiate, summoning and purifying, and as the support in space
The guru and the wheel of Hevajra are invited.
Having meditated on them well, as below, perform prostrations and the rest.
Oneself, emanating and gathering back through the hūṃ,
Makes offerings in sequence through the outer, inner and secret goddesses.
White Gaurī holds the emblem of the deer;
Red Caurī carries the self-arisen flower;
Yellow Vetālī has water in her hand;
Green Ghasmarī holds the secret medicine;
Blue Pukkasī has various kinds of flesh in her hand;
White Śavarī has various tastes in her hand;
Red Caṇḍālī offers sound and a mass of jewels.
The inner offering is made to the three bodies with great bliss:
Ḍombī, the seal, embraces one's own body.
The offering of reality is nonduality.
Confession of wrongdoing, rejoicing, dedication, the offering of one's body,
The teaching of the path and supplication;
Meditate on the four immeasurables, and after the deities have departed,
Phenomena are illusion, one's own mind free of dust.

Recite oṃ śūnyatājñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ, and from recollecting the meaning of that mantra, abide in one's own reality.

From that very nature of reality, raṃ and hūṃ
Become the disc of the sun and the net and tent.
From that, out of e, meditate on the source of phenomena.
Then yaṃ raṃ vaṃ laṃ,
The blue, red, white and yellow seeds,
Transform into the four maṇḍalas of the four elements.
Transformed by one's own mind, the celestial palace,

The supreme city of liberation, shines forth:
Square, with four doors, honored with offerings by goddesses,
With nets and half nets and toraṇas,
Eight pillars and four porticoes,
Ornaments, the wheel of Dharma and a parasol,
Spread through the buddhafields, with hosts of offerings.

In the eight charnel grounds are eight trees and the rest:
The haracuta, the aśoka,
The aśvattha and the karañja,
The jalita and the partipar,
The vete and the bhadra, in the directions and intermediate directions;
Field protectors, direction guardians, gods and nāgas.
The eight field protectors, in face and color,
Are like the eight direction guardians, and so colored too;
Holding a curved knife and a skull cup in right and left,
They receive the torma and protect the fields well.

Śakra (Indra) is white, the lord of elephants,
With vajra and bell in right and left.
Yama is dark blue, riding a buffalo,
With staff and skull cup likewise.
Varuṇa is white, pressing down a makara,
With a snake noose in his right and a lotus in his left.
The yakṣa is yellow, riding a horse,
With a bilva fruit and a mongoose in right and left.
The lord of bhūtas is white,
On a white bull, holding a spear and a skull cup.
The fire god is red, riding a goat,
Carrying a water pot and a three-pointed staff.
The rākṣasa is brownish black, on a throne of a human corpse,
With knife and skull cup in right and left.
Vāyu is smoke-colored, riding a deer,
With a banner in his right and a noose in his left.
All are adorned with jeweled ornaments;
The rākṣasa is adorned with bone.
With wives, sons and retinues, in the colors of their directions,
Through their colors they pacify, and well protect the Dharma.

In the sky above are the eight great gods.
In the east, Śakra, as before.
In the south, Brahmā, golden in color,
Holding a water pot and a three-pointed staff.
In the west, Viṣṇu, red,
With a wheel in his right and a conch in his left.
In the north, the Great God (Śiva), ash-colored,
With trident and skull cup in right and left.
In the northeast, Kumāra, son of the six (Kārttikeya),
White, holding an arrow and a bow.
In the southeast, Gaṇapati, white,
Holding a radish and a sweet cake in right and left.
In the southwest, Bhṛṅgiriṭi, purple,
With a spear in his right and a banner in his left.
In the northwest, black Mahākāla,
With a sword in his right and a shield in his left.
All are endowed with the ornaments of gods,
Surrounded by the gods of desire, the sun, the moon and the planets.

Below, the eight nāgas, in the directions and intermediate directions:
Takṣaka, Śaṅkhapāla, Kulika,
Ananta, Mahāpadma, Nanda,
Vāsuki and Padma,
In the colors of the direction guardians, with a snake noose in the right,
Endowed with hoods, with a lotus in the left.
Eight clouds, eight waters, eight stūpas,
Hosts of birds, beasts of prey and corpses;
Yogins who have attained the supreme accomplishment dwell there.

Within the palace is an eight-petaled lotus,
Encircled by a black vajra garland.
White, yellow, ruby red and black
Are arranged in the order of the directions and the walls.
In the center, the four māras, pressed down by a sun;
On the petals, the eight gods, pressed down by a moon.
On the sun, meditate on a black hūṃ and oṃ.
Below it, from the āli doubled,
The mirrorlike moon, the form of wisdom,
For the arising of the thirty-two marks;

Above, from the kāli doubled,
With ḍa ḍha da dha la ya twice,
The sun of equality, the form of skillful means,
Which accomplishes the eighty minor marks.
White skull cup, blue knife, sun and moon,
And the seeds they symbolize: visualize each distinctly.
Summon, purify, and merge into one: this is the earnest practice.
The body merged into one is the dharmadhātu.

The body is a great dark blue,
With eight faces, four legs and sixteen arms.
The hair, reddish yellow, curls upward.
The upper face is smoke-colored, baring its fangs,
With a wheel of bone and three red eyes.
Of the lower faces, the right is white and the left red;
The central face and the others are the color of the body,
Each with three red eyes, baring the fangs.
On the head a crossed vajra and a crown of skulls;
Earrings, necklace and armlets,
Bracelets and anklets: adorned with ornaments of bone.
A garland of fifty dripping with blood hangs down.
A tiger-skin skirt; smeared with ashes.
The first pair of hands, with vajra and bell,
Lovingly embrace the consort.
The second right hand holds a sword;
Then arrow, wheel and cup,
Staff, trident and hook, in order.
The left hands hold, in order, lotus, bow,
Khaṭvāṅga, skull cup, jewel,
The threatening gesture and the noose.
The consort is of the same color as the father,
With one face and four arms; the first two,
With vajra and bell, embrace the father,
And the other two hold arrow and bow.

She is adorned with a garland of fifty dry skulls;
Her bone ornaments are like the father's.
The principal one, with four legs, the right extended,

Stands upon Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, Upendra and Rudra,
Pressed down by the disc of the sun.
Meditate on him as transformed by the nine dance moods:
Terrifying, erotic, scornful,
Laughing, fierce, compassionate, awesome and peaceful.

Bless the lotus and the vajra:
oṃ padma sukhādhara mahārāga sukhaṃ dadta catur ānanda vagi vaśa hūṃ hūṃ karyaṃ kuru ṣva me.
oṃ vajra mahādveṣa catur ānanda dāyaka khagamukhe karaso nātha hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ karyaṃ kuru śva me.
This is the first union.

As soon as the maṇḍala has been emanated,
The deities enter the mouth and abide in the heart;
Reciting anurāga, they come forth.
gaṃ caṃ vaṃ ghaṃ paṃ śaṃ laṃ ḍaṃ:
These eight radiate in the directions and intermediate directions
Onto the seats of the deities,
And from the five awakenings the goddesses are generated.

Arising from gaṃ and a curved knife,
White Gaurī, with four arms,
Holds arrow, bow, curved knife, and a skull cup of blood;
On the eastern petal she presses down Brahmā.
Generated from caṃ and a ḍamaru,
Red Caurī, with four arms,
Holds wheel, hook and ḍamaru;
On the southern petal she presses down Śakra.
Formed from vaṃ and a tortoise,
Vetālī, white, with four arms,
Holds liquor, water, sword and skull cup;
On the western lotus she presses down Upendra.
Truly generated from ghaṃ and a snake,
Ghasmarī is green, with four arms,
With a hearth, an axe, a skull cup filled with blood,
And the gesture of fearlessness; she stands upon Rudra.
She is to be meditated on, on the northern petal.
Arising from paṃ and a lion,

Pukkasī, yellow, with four arms,
Has a vine of the wish-granting tree, a skull cup filled with flesh,
A jewel and the boon-granting gesture;
Meditate on her in the northeast, pressing down Yama.
Born from śaṃ and a monk,
Śavarī, white, with four arms,
Holds khaṭvāṅga, skull cup, vajra and noose;
Meditate on her in the southeast, pressing down a yakṣa.
Generated from laṃ and a wheel,
Caṇḍālī, blue, with four arms,
Holds a windcloth, a banner and a white skull cup;
Meditate on her in the southwest, pressing down a rākṣasa.
Arising from ḍaṃ and a vajra,
Ḍombī, blue, with four arms,
Holds skull cup, plow, banner,
And a three-pointed spear; pressing down an asura,
Meditate on her on the northwestern lotus.

At the four doors, from jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥdaṅ,
From vajra, jewel, lotus,
And blue sword, and through the awakenings,
Come the horse-faced, the sow-faced, the dog-faced and the lion-faced ones,
With four faces and four arms, on seats of corpses.
The first has the right face yellow, the left red, the front blue;
The upper face, a horse's head, is green.
Two hands hold a flute, and the other two
Hold a vajra and a hook.
The second has the right face blue, the left red, the front yellow;
The upper face, a sow's head, is red.
Two hands hold a vīṇā, and the other two
Hold a jewel and a noose.
The third has the right face blue, the left white, the middle red;
The upper face, a dog's head, is yellow.
Two hands hold a great drum, and the other two
Hold a lotus and an iron chain.
The fourth has the right face blue, the left white, the middle green;
The upper face, a lion's head, is white.

Two hands hold a clay drum, and likewise the other two
Hold the sword and the secret bell.
In order, beginning at the eastern door,
Meditate on them upon lotus, sun and corpse.
All have three red, round eyes,
Their reddish-yellow hair blazing upward;
Naked, with tiger skins wound about their waists,
They bear the five bone ornaments,
And a garland of dried heads hangs down.
With left legs extended, in forms erotic and terrifying,
They sit on their own seats in the directions and intermediate directions.

Entering the syllables, the principal one melts:
Above the sun, hūṃ and aṃ
Abide in the form of a drop of bliss.
Then the goddesses of the retinue,
Not seeing their own principal,
Their minds tormented with great longing, wishing him to arise,
Urge the principal with vajra songs:

"Venerable one, arise with your compassionate heart!
Join me in great bliss!
Abandon the nature of emptiness
And protect me, Pukkasī!"

"If you do not remain, I shall die:
Do not cut off the stream of your compassion; arise!
Why do you remain in the nature of emptiness?
Bring Śavarī's fruit to fulfillment!"

"Lord of joy, host of the world,
Do you remain in emptiness?
I, Caṇḍālī, make this plea:
Blessed Vajra, Vajra, arise!
I long for your heart;
You who command illusion, arise!"

"I, Ḍombī, am losing my senses:
You have cut off your great compassion; arise!"

Hearing these dreamlike sounds,
The Blessed Hevajra arises as before.
Meditate on his body color and the rest as before,
And look well upon the maṇḍalas.
At the hearts of the deities, lotus, sun and moon;
Meditate on their own hand emblems and seeds.
This is the supreme king of the maṇḍala.

With the light rays from the principal's heart,
Invite the gnosis maṇḍala;
It abides in the sky over the eastern charnel ground.
Offer well the outer, inner and secret offerings,
And through Gaurī and the other three goddesses,
With jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ, summon, absorb and bind it;
Having generated delight, meditate on nonduality.

To generate the higher knowledges,
The six faculties, the eye and the rest, should be purified.
maṃ dhaṃ naṃ raṃ aṃ naṃ,
White, black, yellow, red, green and black;
From lotus, moon, seed and curved knife,
Delusion, Aversion, Avarice,
Attachment, Envy and Nairātmyā,
The six goddesses bearing vajra names:
Having summoned and purified, meditate on them as goddesses,
With the five ornaments, curved knife and skull cup,
All with the left leg extended.
At the crown of the head, the heart and the throat,
From a white oṃ, a red āḥ and a black hūṃ,
From curved knives of the three colors,
Summoned, purified and blessed as the three bodies,
Come Bhūcarī, Khecarī and Nairātmyā,
White, red and black, holding curved knives,
With the five ornaments, on seats of corpses;
Meditate on them with the left leg extended, in erotic grace.

Again, from the seed in one's own heart,
Five lights radiate, summoning and purifying.
To the guru, the maṇḍala and the Victors,
Together with the wrathful ones and the knowledge goddesses,

Make excellent offerings with the three kinds of offering,
And supplicate them for the sake of empowerment:
oṃ sarva tathāgata abhiṣiñcatu māṃ.
The buddhas, Akṣobhya and the rest,
And Locanā and the rest, arising from their bodies,
Confer empowerment, deities with vases of nectar:
oṃ sarva tathāgata abhiṣekata samaya śrīye hūṃ.
The two obscurations are purified, and the seal is set:
For oneself, Gaurī and Pukkasī,
The Blessed Akṣobhya is well seated;
For Śavarī and Caurī,
Vairocana is likewise seated;
For Caṇḍālī and Vetālī,
Meditate on Ratnasambhava;
For Ḍombī and Ghasmarī,
Amitābha is seated on the head.

Then one should taste the nectar.
In the sky of the southeastern charnel ground,
On the crowns of the four,
Meditate in order on Vairocana and the others.
yaṃ raṃ aṃ, the three, a black hāṃ, and oṃ:
Meditate on these in order from below upward.
Reciting hūṃ, with the light of the hūṃ in one's own heart,
Urged by hūṃ, in front, a maṇḍala,
Three heads and eight lotuses;
Meditate on a skull cup together with the seeds.
Likewise, when the light of hūṃ has urged the father,

By the light of a, the seeds
Are transformed and become nectar:
From hūṃ, an emanation; from bhrūṃ, scent;
From jṝṃ, the white; from aṃ, the red;
From khaṃ, it turns to liquid, the mountain of the directions;
From naṃ, human flesh; from haṃ, horse;
From naṃ, elephant; from ṣaṃ,
Jackal; from gaṃ, the flesh of the ox.
The fire of hūṃ is kindled, and the nectar boils.

A moon disc arising from a falls upon it.
The hūṃ itself becomes a vajra,
Leaps up five times and stirs it.
With the light of the vajra, hūṃ and oṃ,
The gnosis nectar is invited and mingles with it.
On the tongues of the deities, from hūṃ itself,
A vajra tube arises, through which they taste the nectar:
oṃ sarva tathāgata amṛta vajra svabhava ātmako'haṃ.

Then the offering goddesses
Make offerings in order to the deities of the maṇḍala.
In the sequence of offering and so forth,
They present the outer, inner and secret offerings:
oṃ sarva tathāgata pūjā vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ.
All the knowledge goddesses
Sing praises to the deities of the maṇḍala:

"Blessed One, encircled by the maṇḍala of goddesses,
Whose heart pervades the moving and the unmoving,
You who accomplish the good of all beings,
Blessed One, supreme Hevajra,
Who fulfill the intent of speech and mind,
Be pleased, O Hevajra!"
oṃ sarva tathāgata stuti vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ.

Having become stable, turn the wheel:
The deities should be radiated into every direction,
And all beings to the very ends of space
Should be clearly meditated on as deities of the maṇḍala.
Having become stable, gather them back,
And meditate clearly on oneself as the maṇḍala.
This is the supreme wheel of the king of action;
This is the reality of the deity.

One who despises the guru, is faithless, and is proud about mantra,
Puffed up from seeing books, and lowly in empowerment:
To such a one, not even a single word should be spoken.
The faithful, who have gained the four realities, strive devotedly in practice;
Those who have received the guru's transmission, remember his kindness, and

revere the guru:
The one is like someone who has fallen from the summit of the king of mountains:
Though he thinks, "I shall not fall," he falls nonetheless.
For the others, free from wrongdoing, the stages of gnosis will increase.

This is the stage of the reality of the deity, the first.

Now the reality of gnosis is explained.

Since everything is one's own mind,
The gathering of the deities into oneself
Is like breath blown upon the surface of a mirror
Fading away step by step.
The four, the horse-faced one and the rest,
Should be gathered into the four limbs;
The eight goddesses are gathered into the faces,
And the faces and arms in order,
So that self and object each have one face and two arms.
Then the four cakras supported from elsewhere
Are meditated on, and one meditates on the arising
Of the eight signs that arise from below;
Or else, not to be rejected, this is the instruction on the meaning of the tantra.
Here, through the guru's instruction,
As if one had received the deity's prophecy,
One attains the mahāmudrā in the intermediate state.

The characteristics of the secret lotus,
And the stages of manifest awakening
In which mind and gnosis have mingled,
Should be heard at the gnosis empowerment.
The vajra holder of the stages of awakening
Relies rightly on the four places.
In delightful places,
Seated on a comfortable seat,
Having abandoned attachment and the rest in turn,
And having thought, with compassion, of benefiting
All things, stable and moving,
One should generate the mind of equality.
Below, and Akaniṣṭha, the end of sound,

And likewise the secret lotus,
With various parts and colors,
And likewise the others:
Through the vajra of body, speech and mind,
These are the play of the dharmadhātu.
Gathered together by the yoga of the lump,
One becomes Vajrasattva oneself.
The elements of water and fire
Become of one taste, and so the supreme state is reached.
From the union of wisdom and skillful means,
The six faculties are buddhahood itself.
Knowing the reality of the true treatise,
Following the master's transmission,
Meditating on the meaning of that great secret reality,
Passed down from one to one, the holder of that reality,
Having marked everything as before
With the marks of emptiness, reality and the rest,
With a body washed of stains,
Is liberated by the stages of manifest awakening.

In the center of a moon disc
One should meditate on the gnosis being.
From the moon disc rays radiate;
White in color like jasmine and the moon,
With both legs in the cross-legged posture of a sattva,
Fully adorned with all ornaments,
Wearing a crown of the five buddhas,
His two hands, bound in the great seal,
Are held at his own heart.
His form is beautiful and utterly perfect;
Imagine him on a seat of the gnosis lotus.
The heart is like the flower of the plantain tree,
And abides hanging down from the navel.
As before, it is adorned as a blossoming lotus;
Upon it, adorned with eight petals,
With stamens and a moon,
One should place the seed syllables.

Dwelling in the maṇḍala of the navel,
With one face and two arms, white in color,
Excrement should be meditated on in the center.
In its center, meditate on consciousness
And gnosis as nondual.
Endowed first with loving-kindness,
Akṣobhya is on the eastern petal.
Great compassion is at the southern door;
Ratna itself is the seed.

Joy is on the petal of the western door:
There place the seed of Amitābha.
Equanimity is on the northern petal:
There imagine Amoghasiddhi as the principal.
From emptiness without characteristics,
The seeds, the vowels, beginning in the east,
Endowed with half moon and drop,
Are to be placed in order, clad in white.
On the four petals of the intermediate directions
Place the neuter letters taught before.
In its center, one's own mind
Should be meditated on as a letter itself.

"From emptiness without characteristics,
How is one to meditate on letters?
The mind is filled with wonder.
Blessed One, how is this to be explained?"
Then the Blessed One said:
"Vajra, listen to reality just as it is.
From the marking of emptiness's characteristic,
Like the nectar of the plantain flower,
What has no essence becomes the essence.
The consciousness in the center is gnosis;
Gnosis by nature is formless,
Characterized by having no characteristics,
The stainless body of gnosis,
Fully free of both thing and no-thing,
Without color, shape or letter.

In the middle between form and emptiness
The yogin should grasp that reality.
With the mind of equality
One should meditate on the characteristics just as they are.
Its path of perfect awakening,
In accordance with the guru's own transmission,
Will now quickly be seen.
Consciousness, gnosis and forms:
Their characteristics are taught in the treatises,
And that reality alone has been explained by the Hero.
Adorned with white light rays,
This should always be meditated on.

On the stūpa of the five graces,
Having imagined the seed of nectar,
White light rays of clear radiance,
From the stream of nectar trickling down,
On the stamens of the lotus of the heart,
On a round disc the size of a thumb,
In its center the seed
Drawn from the vowels and consonants,
White in color and exceedingly beautiful,
Radiating moonlight in every direction.
At the doors of its center
Meditation on the drop is renowned:
A hundredth part of the tip of a hair,
It always abides in the form of an atom.
Possessed of gnosis that marks the characteristics
Of the thing that is consciousness,
Since one does not know the characteristic of mind,
Look at the state where the drop abides.
At the heart and the aperture of Brahmā,
And at the doors of the path of the drop,
With devotion to the guru's transmission,
One should grasp consciousness and gnosis.
It is not found in the paths of outsiders
Nor in the treatises;

And though the teaching is easy to find,
It is hard to find through its application.
Through devoted service to the guru,
The practitioner endowed with skillful means,
The wise one, should meditate on this
By the path from the guru's mouth.
In a place unshaken and free from harm,
Resting in equipoise, meditate on the thing.
Mind is the forerunner of phenomena:
By mind one enters, and by mind one is purified.
By the kindness of the king, mind,
Speakers come to act.
Therefore everything has the nature of mind;
The intelligent say it arises from mind.

If the yogin wishes to recite,
It is the thought and meditation of the heart.
The seed that is vow and transforming continuum
Is that very reality, without form.
The seed of cause and of fruit
Is gnosis, that reality, which is not seen.
For the sensual enjoyments of existence, form and the rest,
One should meditate on the five seeds.
Entering everywhere and in every way,
They abide rightly in the moving and the unmoving.
The root should always be fixed as with a nail.
The seed of gnosis and consciousness
Is endowed with the sound of the drop.
Wishing for the enjoyments of existence,
Abandoning the letters of speech,
Endowed with mental recitation,
One abides continually in the unmoving state
Of the permanent dharmadhātu itself.
Through constant casting off, without attachment,
Consciousness dissolves into gnosis.
When consciousness becomes gnosis itself,
The stages of awakening are seen, it is said.

Appearance like a lamp in everything
Is the first sign.
Like a firefly, and the seeing of motes:
This is the second sign,
Defined by its characteristic of destroying the afflictions.
Seeing likewise in the directions
The aspect of white atoms:
Know this to be the third sign.
Seeing with the mind the enjoyments
Of the gods of desire is the fourth;
Seeing the gods of form is the fifth;
The domain of the formless is the sixth;
Abiding in the dharmadhātu is the seventh;
The fruit of buddhahood is the eighth.
The yogin should meditate without distraction.
When the yogin endowed with compassion
Meditates one-pointedly, he will attain the supreme.
The yogin who meditates on gnosis
Should receive the instruction on where to transfer
From one who has the guru's lineage;
At death, conceptual thought goes to the realm of the sky-goers.

Whoever is faithless, lazy, foolish and without wisdom,
Looks for the guru's faults, speaks ill, deceives the guru with guile,
Does not look to him in assembly, scorns him in private, and speaks with mocking words:
Even if he is a son, a king, a monk or of noble family, give him up.
To one who has abandoned these faults, who is not merely of outward conduct,
Who reveres the guru, has compassion and benefits others, with wisdom and skillful means,
Undistracted in the four modes of conduct, diligent in meditation, taught in stages:
To such a one the reality of mantra should be well taught.

This is the stage of the reality of gnosis, the second.

Then the characteristics of mantra are explained.
Yogins should always recite.
Mantra and letter are not different;

Always reciting nondually:
If the yogin wishes to recite,
It is thought and meditation with the heart.
The seed that has become the vajra cause:
That reality is formless.
Around the seed at one's own heart,
Encircle it with the mantra of meditative concentration and recite:
oṃ deva picu vajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
This is the heart mantra.
oṃ aṣṭānanāya piṃga urdha keśa vartmana caturviṃśatinetrāya ṣoḍaśabhujāya kṛṣṇajīmūtavapuṣe kapālamālānekādhāriṇi ādhmātakrūracittāya ardhendudaṃṣṭīṇe oṃ māraya māraya kāraya kāraya garjjaya garjjaya tarjjaya tarjjaya śoṣaya śoṣaya sapta sāgarāna bandha bandha nāga aṣṭakāna gṛhna gṛhna sarva duṣṭāṃ ṣatrūṃ ha hā hi hī hu hū he hai ho hau haṃ haḥ phaṭ svāhā.
This is the root mantra.
oṃ vajra ghujusita paramalokeśvare kapāla māladhariṇi rudhipṛye napasi hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
This is the heart mantra of Gaurī.
oṃ vajra caṇḍeśvāri khaṭvāṃgi mahāvajra kapāla māla kuho ākaḍḍhya sarva duṣṭāṃ hṛdaya ākaḍḍhya bhu hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
This is Caurī's.
oṃ vajra vettālī kha kha khāhī sarva duṣṭaṃ vikaṭa veśetarini vikṛta ālaṃkāra bhūṣita hana hana daha daha paca paca pilaṃpasamanusmāra praśaya maṇṭalmate utapaya sarva hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ svāhā.
This is Vetālī's.

oṃ vajra maheśvari haṃ haṃ haṃ haṃ rulu bhyo hūṃ phaṭ pakhrayaṃ sarva duṣṭānīṃ nirmathaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Ghasmarī's.
oṃ vajra habhavati vajra gujaśarava hūṃ picita viśitarina sarva tathāgatā justhe samayamanusmāra hana hana raṃga raṃgaya sphura sphuraya āveśa sarva bhūtaṃta nadha nadha sataya ha ha ha ha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Pukkasī's.
oṃ piśāci parṇaśavarī sarva mariraṃ praśamani hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ mohaputari hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Śavarī's.

oṃ vajra sulaṃni bhinda sarva duṣṭāṃ hṛdaya ākarṣaya ākarṣaya hana hana daha daha nirmatharaya vilaṃba samayamanusmāra hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Caṇḍālī's.
oṃ vajra varama ghujai kasala vibhūṣita sarva duṣṭāṃ mohani priye jyehi gapati vajra bhūje saribha hūṃ vaṃ vaṃ vasaparini sarva duṣṭāṃ cauniri hūṃ phaṭ
Ḍombī.
oṃ vajra vaḍavamukhaṃ yogeśvari hi hi hi hi jaḥ hū phaṭ svāhā
This is Hayāsyā's.
jitapara
oṃ vajra daṃyu vārāhamukhī traṃ hū phaṭ svāhā
This is Sūkarāsyā's.
oṃ vajra sādhu saṃjelini mahāyakṣani kṣani rūpani mahāphalayani ranate kāmaruvati taṃtra daho hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Śvānāsyā's.
oṃ candra sūrya hū trāsani siṃhanirte siṃhavagate saṃheni taṃ taṃ taṃ vaṃ vaṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
These are the mantras of Siṃhāsyā and the others.
oṃ aṃ svāhā
This is Nairātmyā's.
oṃ iṃ svāhā
Gaurī.
oṃ āṃ svāhā
This is Caurī's.
oṃ īṃ svāhā
This is Vetālī's.
oṃ oṃ svāhā
This is Ghasmarī's.
oṃ ūṃ svāhā
This is Pukkasī's.
oṃ ṛ svāhā
This is Śavarī's.
oṃ ṝ laṃ svāhā
This is Caṇḍālī's.
oṃ ḷṃ svāhā
This is Ḍombī's.
These are the root mantras.

oṃ hyagriva hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Hayāsyā's.
oṃ vajra sūragriva hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Sūkarāsyā's.
oṃ kukuragṛva hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
This is Śvānāsyā's.
oṃ vajra sidhagriva hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
These are the long heart mantras of Siṃhāsyā and the others.

The yogin who is diligent in recitation
pays homage to the sites with the five syllables.
The peaceful drop, its shape and color moist;
bliss, nonconceptuality, emptiness;
nonconceptuality and emptiness as nondual:
recite at each stage according to the guru's instructions.

One who sees the guru as ordinary, who clears away poison yet rejects the nectar,
who is puffed up with lineage and honors, and who seeks the eight worldly concerns:
when such a disciple comes, out of compassion hold on to even that bit of virtue.
One who is calm, gentle and diligent, who carries out the commands, and who studies, reflects and meditates,
though lineage, standing and wealth are needed, such a one should be accepted and trained;
he is worthy to be given empowerment, the explanation of the tantra, mantras and instructions.

This was the third, the stage of the reality of mantra.

Now I shall explain the reality of the self.
By knowing that reality, there is no separate meditative equipoise.
The purity of all entities
is declared to be suchness.
Afterwards, distinguishing them one by one,
the deities are to be established as pure.
Having purified the covering obscuration of ignorance,
the aggregates, elements and sense sources of the embodied one

are the five families, the five consorts, the vajra ladies.
One, two, three, four, five and ten,
hundreds, thousands, ten thousands, hundred thousands, ten millions,
countless: the secret of body is inconceivable;
the nonduality of speech and mind is inconceivable.
For the benefit of yogins,
the bodiless Vajra-holder himself
is the supreme perfection of wisdom.
All these three realms
are just like a dream or an illusion.
Cast far away the thoughts of the eight worldly concerns,
and ascertain the nondual and nonconceptual.
By practicing the six perfections,
the accomplishment of buddhahood is swiftly attained.
Not conceiving of sentient beings, who are made by illusion,
engaging oneself in the dharmadhātu,
wander alone without companions,
and with a mind free of fear,
dwell at ease as one pleases.
Just as one who seeks nectar
takes the essence and discards the dregs,
so, having found the five nectars
and abandoned all conceptual thought,
just as all the buddhas have taught,
enjoy nonconceptual samādhi.
Throughout all the tantras the Victor has taught:
through conceptual thought one goes to hell
and goes into the ocean of saṃsāra with its six classes of beings;
without conceptual thought one becomes liberated
and goes to the state of Mahāmudrā.
Therefore the yogin himself,
knowing the true meaning,
with compassion, intent on the welfare of beings,
should investigate steadily without any reference point,
and roam without fear like a lion.
Nevertheless, one should not disparage the master,
nor be other than pleased with one's vajra brothers and sisters.

The root and branch commitments
must never be abandoned on the grounds of illusion.
Knowing the ten realities, through generation and completion,
one should accomplish omniscience.
The great yogin, adorned in emulation of Vajrasattva, the wisdom of diversity,
some on the excellent path that pacifies the afflictions, accomplishing body, speech and mind, the result
being like an illusion, a mirage, a city of gandharvas, with their minds resting in samādhi,
should heal themselves and others, sick with desire and the rest, with the medicine of illusion-like wisdom.
Whoever has not obtained from the guru
the instructions on self-blessing,
by focusing on permanence and annihilation,
that person has turned back.
Setting aside all other offerings,
properly undertake the offering to the guru.
By pleasing him, one will attain
the supreme wisdom of omniscience.
By making offerings to the master
who has attained the unsurpassed, Vajrasattva,
what merit has one not made,
what austerity has one not undertaken?
Whatever is most delightful,
longed for as that inexhaustible reality,
whatever is most excellent,
that very thing the guru bestows.
The guru takes away evil;
the master dispels fear;
the master carries one across
the fearsome ocean of suffering.
Whoever is puffed up with pride,
disparages the genuine instructions,
and holds the Dharma of reality in contempt,
to such a one reality is not taught.
To those who are devoted to the guru and speak the truth,
who are learned and of single-minded disposition,

and who guard the commitments and the conduct,
to them this stage should be taught.

This was the fourth, the stage of the reality of the self.

For the yogin who meditates on the four realities,
in order to purify obscurations and pacify obstacles,
to gather the accumulations and to transfer to Khecarī,
give torma to the Dharma protectors and the ḍākinīs.
In the sky above the eastern charnel ground,
in the middle of a triple-stacked source of phenomena,
at the center, from maṃ, the earth goddess Pṛthivī,
golden in color, holding a vase,
adorned with every ornament,
gracefully seated on a lotus and moon seat,
surrounded by hosts of pretas of the sky.
In the directions and intermediate directions, beginning with the east,
are the charnel grounds as taught, with the guardians of the directions and their retinues.
At the center of the lotus above,
from baṃ, Brahmā, four-faced and golden in color,
holding in his right hands the gesture of fearlessness and a rosary,
and in his left a water pot and a trident,
sits surrounded by the gods of the form realm.
From paṃ, at the center of a lotus,
from phu, Padma, white, white as a white lotus,
with a serpent hood, holding a snake noose and a lotus.
In the directions and intermediate directions, the eight great nāgas
are to be visualized like the charnel grounds as taught.
The deities of the directions and intermediate directions are visualized as before,
surrounded by a retinue of the gods of the desire realm.
Reciting jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ in order,
by Gaurī and the other goddesses
they are summoned and absorbed and become nondual.
Then the guardians of the directions with their retinues are of the mind family:
Akṣobhya himself, adorned with charnel ornaments,
dark blue, with vajra, bell and consort,

one-faced, with the right leg extended: so should one visualize.
The gods are of the body family,
white, possessed of charnel ornaments,
with vajra, bell and consort,
one-faced, with the right leg extended: so should one visualize.
The eight nāgas are of the speech family, red,
of the nature of Amitābha, with charnel ornaments,
red in color, with vajra, bell and consort,
one-faced, with the right leg extended: so should one visualize.
Each with their own ornaments, and body, speech and mind,
their tongues taste through vajra tubes;
see yourself as having tasted the nectar.
Having blessed the three tormas,
the offering to the guardians of the directions is this:
oṃ inda jama jala jakkha bhūta vahṇi vāu rākkha canda sujja māda pappa tala pātāla aṣṭha sappa svāhā idaṃ baliṃ bhuñja jiṃgha phulla dhūppa māṃsa piṃga amba sabba kajja sada khānti khuṇi phaṭ gāda
oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarva dharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
kolla iri ḍṭhi a bolā mummuṇi re kakkolā ghaṇe kṛpita ho bājjai karuṇe kiai ṇa rolā tahiṃ bala khājjai ghaḍheṃ maanā pijjaai hale kāliṃ jara paṇiai dundura bajjiai causama kātthuri sihla kappuralā iai māla indhaṇaṃ sāliñja tihaṃ bharu khāiai phreṃ khaṇa kheṭa karante śudhā śuddhana muṇiai nirāṃśu aṃge caṭāviai tahiṃ jasa rāva paniai malayaja kunduru vaṭṭai ḍiṇḍima tahinna vājjaai
So it is with this vajra song.
All the limbs are to be completed. Having given the outer and inner scattered offerings and drink:
oṃ vajrasatva samaya manupālaya vajrasatva tvenopatiṣṭha ḍiḍho me bhava sutoṣyo me bhava anurakto me bhava supoṣyo me bhava sarva siddhimme brayaccha sarva karmasu ca me cittaṃ śreyaḥ kuru hūṃ ha ha ha ha hoḥ bhagavān sarva tathāgata vajra māme muñca vajrī bhava mahā samaya satva aḥ

Having visualized oneself as the deity, with both hands
one should turn the lotus mudrā.
Saying hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ three times, ring the bell;

with vajra and bell, join the palms at the heart.
Having generated great compassion,
sing the vajra song and make the aspiration:
To the Three Jewels, free of evil and obscuration,
free of faults such as desire,
having entirely abandoned the grasped and the grasper,
to suchness I pay homage.
Beautiful as phenomena that are like illusions,
emanating the two, purifying the two, nondual,
acting through illusion for the sake of embodied beings,
free of entities: to you I pay homage.
May all sentient beings be free of evil;
may all sentient beings be happy;
may they meet with buddhahood itself.
Having entered upon that very path,
may those who have not crossed be brought across,
and may those not liberated be liberated.
May they abide, right now,
in the Dharma of yoga and the commitments.
Place the left fist at the heart;
extending the right hand, request the deities to depart:
sarva ghaṭanṛ gṛhna gṛhna hūṃ phaṭ oṃ āḥ hūṃ muḥ
When unable to keep to meditative concentration, lie down
in the perfection of method and wisdom.
When rising, be roused by the song of the goddesses;
having risen, bathe, thinking of it as empowerment.
Torma, maṇḍala, offerings and the rest
are to be done together with the conferral.
Offer the first portion of food, and taste it as nectar.
Whatever one does in the four modes of conduct,
practice it through the stages of the four realities.
Relying on the tantras and the guru's instructions,
I have composed this sādhana of the four stages of Hevajra.
By whatever stainless virtue has been gathered from this,
may all beings accomplish Hevajra.

The Hevajra sādhana called The Stages of the Four Realities, composed by the master Kambala, is complete. It was translated, edited and finalized by the paṇḍita Vairocanarakṣita and the translator Lan Darma Lodrö.

Translator's Notes

• The names of the eight charnel-ground trees are given as the Tibetan spells them; several (haracuta, jalita, partipar, vete) are not securely identifiable. In Viṣṇu's left hand the text reads "smoke" (dud), taken as a slip for "conch" (dung). Among Hevajra's right-hand attributes, the word gshor is obscure; it is rendered "cup" on the assumption of a drinking vessel, which is uncertain. "Field-born" consort and "knowledge consort" render the technical terms kṣetrajā and vidyā. "Mind streams" renders rgyud in the sense of continuum, not tantra.
• Vetālī is described here as white (reading dkar for kar), whereas earlier, among the offering goddesses, she was yellow. Ghasmarī's source is read as "snake" (sbrul) for "emanation" (sprul). After the six colors the text has a stray "lotus, black," apparently a repetition, which is left untranslated. The fourth door guardian's "secret" attribute is taken as the bell, following the pattern of hook, noose, chain and bell. The line on Ḍombī's plea lacks the negative found in Śavarī's ("do not cut off"); it is translated as it stands. The closing lines on preparing the nectar ("the four," "in front, a maṇḍala") are terse and their sense uncertain. "Five awakenings" renders the fivefold abhisambodhi of the generation stage.
• The list of syllables transforming into the nectars and meats is terse: "from hūṃ, an emanation" and "from khaṃ, it turns to liquid, the mountain of the directions" are translated as written, and their exact referents are unclear. "Excrement" follows the technical sense of dri chen in tantric rites, where it corresponds to Vairocana among the five nectars; the line could also be read as "great fragrance." The verse on the unworthy and the worthy student lists both groups before giving the simile and the result; the simile of falling is taken to apply to the first group, and the increase of gnosis to the second.
• "Northern petal" reads dab ma for the written bab ma. "Clad in white" (gos dkar ldan pa) may instead allude to the goddess Pāṇḍaravāsinī; the sense of the line is uncertain. Several lines in the section on recitation ("the seed that is vow and transforming continuum," "through constant casting off") are compressed and translated literally. The "Vajra" addressed by the Blessed One is presumably Vajragarbha, the interlocutor of the Hevajra Tantra.
• The line ending "recite at each stage" renders □□□□□□□, whose sense is uncertain. In the verse on the root and branch commitments, □□□□□□□ is taken as "never": the commitments are not to be discarded on the pretext that all is illusion. □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□ "austerity", and □□□□□ "obtained" as □□□□ "contempt", both evident scribal slips. In the line on the guru, □□□□□ is instrumental, so the guru is the one who bestows. In the label after the seed mantra oṃ ḷṃ svāhā, the stray syllable □□ after Ḍombī's name is left untranslated. □□□□□□□□ stands on its own between two mantras and is given as written.
• The line on sleep (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is terse. It is read as "when one is unable to keep to meditation, lie down within method and wisdom", that is, the yoga of sleep. In "done together with the conferral" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), the sense of □□□□□□□ is uncertain. The author's name □□□□□□ is taken as Kambala.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.